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2000 - 125

Red 5/21/00 wpl

SPECIES: BLACKBURNIAN WARBLER | DENDROICA FUSCA
 (Vernacular Name) (Scientific Name)

DATE(S): 5/9/00 TIME OF OBSERVATION: 10:55 AM TO 11:00

EXACT LOCATION: ENVIRONMENTAL LEARNING CENTER

NEAREST TOWN: FT. COLLINS COUNTY: LARIMER

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO INDEPENDENTLY IDENTIFIED THIS BIRD:

BILL LISOWSKY

OPTICAL EQUIPMENT: BAUSCH & LOMB CUSTOM 8X36 BINOCULARS

WEATHER CONDITIONS: SUNNY AND BRIGHT

BIRD/SUN ORIENTATION: BIRD IN FRONT, SUN BEHIND AND TO RIGHT

DISTANCE FROM BIRD AND HOW MEASURED: 20 FEET APPROXIMATED

NUMBER OF BIRDS SEEN: 1 SEX: MALE PLUMAGE: BREEDING

BEHAVIOR AND DEMEANOR: I NOTICED A MAGGILLIVAYS WARBLER, AND AS I WATCHED IT, A SMALL BIRD MOVED IN A COTTONWOOD ABOVE THE MAC. THIS BIRD WOULD HOP FROM BRANCH TO BRANCH PICKING INSECTS FROM THE LEAVES AND BRANCHES. THE FIRST LOOK THAT I GOT OF THIS BIRD WAS THE BRIGHT ORANGE UNDERPARTS

HEAD & NECK (forehead, crown, auricular & malar regions, median line, etc.):

THE TOP OF THE CROWN HAD A YELLOWISH-ORANGE CENTRAL STRIPE ON A BLACK BACKGROUND. THE BLACK EDGINS TO THE STRIPE CONTINUED AS TWO BLACK LINES MEETING AT THE BILL.

EYES & LORES (supercilium, eye-ring, eye-stripe, color, etc.): THE FACE WAS BRIGHT ORANGE WITH BLACK TRIANGULAR EAR PATCH THAT EXTENDED FORWARD AS A LINE THROUGH THE EYE TO THE BILL. THERE WAS AN ORANGE SPOT

LOWER & UPPER MANDIBLES (color & shape): BLACK THIN POINTY BILL BELOW EYE WITHIN BLACK TRIANGLE

LEGS & FEET: DID NOT GET A GOOD LOOK

UPPERPARTS (nape, back, rump, uppertail coverts, etc.): BLACKISH FROM TOP OF CROWN (AT REAR END OF CENTRAL STRIPE) TO RUMP

UNDERPARTS (chin, throat, belly, sides, flanks, crissum, etc.): ORANGE (BRIGHTEST AREA AT THROAT EXTENDING DOWN TO UPPER BREAST) FADING TO YELLOWISH ON FLANKS AND LOWER BELLY; SOME DARK STREAKING ALONG FLANKS; LIGHT YELLOWISH WHITE ON UNDERTAIL COVERTS

RETRICES (inner, middle & outer tail feathers; color, pattern, shape, etc.):

I DID NOT GET A GOOD LOOK AT TAIL

WINGS (color, length, shape, bars, coverts, etc.): DARKISH WITH A VERY PRONOUNCED WHITE WING PATCH EXTENDING ACROSS GREATER WING COVERTS. THE GENERAL SENSE THAT I HAD WAS THAT THE WINGS WERE BLACKISH LIKE THE BACK

VOCALIZATION (call/song, method of delivery, i.e., from perch, in flight): A SHORT SERIES OF TWO-NOTE SEET CALLS FOLLOWED BY A VERY SHORT TRILL MUCH HIGHER PITCHED THAN FIRST PART OF CALL

HABITAT: RIPARIAN AREA ALONG RIVER

ELIMINATION OF SIMILARLY APPEARING SPECIES:

THIN POINTY BILL RULES OUT MOST PASSERINES, BRIGHT ORANGE COLOR UNDERNEATH RULES OUT OTHER PASSERINES EXCEPT WARBLERS. TOWNSEND'S WARBLER RULED OUT BY BLACK BACK AND SOLID ORANGE THROAT AND UPPER BREAST. CAPE MAY RULED OUT BY UNSTREAKED ORANGE THROAT AND UPPER BREAST, BY BLACK NOT BROWN EAR PATCH AND BY BLACK BACK. MAGNOLIA RULED OUT BY ORANGE UNDERPARTS AND LACK OF STREAKING ON BREAST AND BY ORANGISH FACE AND YELLOW CENTRAL CROWN STRIPE ON BLACK HEAD.

PRIOR EXPERIENCE WITH THIS AND SIMILARLY APPEARING SPECIES:

I HAVE SEEN QUITE A FEW BLACKBURNIAN WARBLERS IN ILLINOIS AND HAVE SEEN CAPE MAY, MAGNOLIA AND TOWNSEND'S WARBLERS IN COLORADO. THIS IS MY FIRST MALE BLACKBURNIAN IN COLORADO

BOOKS, ILLUSTRATIONS AND ADVICE CONSULTED THAT INFLUENCED THIS REPORT:

NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC

THIS REPORT WRITTEN FROM NOTES MADE DURING ☒ AFTER ☐ OBSERVATION; ☐ FROM MEMORY

NAME: JOE MAMMOSER SIGNATURE: Joe Mammoser DATE: 5/15/00